



(FROM LEFT) SESSION CHAIRPERSON RAHUL KANWAL, PURUSHOTHAMAN, HOODA, DUBASH, THOTTUMKAL, KAPOOR AND D'SOUZA

he had was optimism, vision and hard work. Idealistically, the world should have been kind to his vision, the bosses should have been his guiding angels, colleagues should have been welcoming comrades. In reality, he gets trapped in vicious circles of humiliation but manages to create an idealistic world for himself. Youngsters speak in a different language, 'no' for them means now, 'how' means somehow and that is the way of living which is simply 'wow'. Today, youngsters are not only living in an idealistic world but are even earning their living out of it. In my view, idea in idealism has paved way for real in reality. As a kid born in a family of accomplished actors, I used to dream of being taken seriously as an actor. That was idealism. Today, I have been given this opportunity to share the dais with some of the most esteemed celebrated dignitaries as Ranbir Kapoor, the actor. That is reality to me. Reality does merge with idealism.

“Small choices can make a difference and change things”

ASIN THOTTUMKAL ACTOR

My father said, “Anyone who is not a rebel before 35 and a rebel after the age of 35 is not a normal person”. The youth today has a strong desire for change and that's how ideals are born. But as reality sets in and as life goes on, we tend to mellow down and comprise ideals for the sake of survival. This compromise, whether we do or not or to what extent, determines the change that we can bring about.

In the film industry, we find scores and scores of artistes, filmmakers, technicians and actors who start with new ideas but in an effort to gain a foothold here, lose it all. Here everything and everybody is a commodity, exactly replaceable by the next talented non-name. The jostle never ends. Actors and directors in general are criticised for being sellouts. People often watch films and wonder how could someone work on these films. But if one person refuses, then he or she will be replaced by the next commodity and the juggernaut will roll on. Mediocre products continue to be made because

people are not willing to take risks. As an actor, it would mean lesser endorsements, lesser visibility, lesser media coverage and lesser so-called industry friends. But I think it is the only way to get soul into the business. Small choices that you make for that extra money, popularity or fame makes the difference. Selling values and integrity is never one clean sweep; it's a layered process. Everybody and not just the youth is capable of change. Small changes can make a difference in the society and bring about many bigger changes in the long-term. It is a sincere attempt at steering reality towards idealism for progress and development of the nation.

“We need to expand the opportunities for others”

ROOPA PURUSHOTHAMAN MD, HEAD OF RESEARCH, EVERSTONE INVESTMENT ADVISORS

India has taught me that we are not just agents of change; we are also agents of connection. Actually, when I first came to India, I was 16. I found out the question that I really wanted to spend the rest of my life answering: why some countries are rich and others are poor? India is more than a country, more than its roads, cities, villages, even more than its sum of people. To me India is an idea and a really powerful idea. It invites contradiction, it celebrates clamour, discourse, diversity of life, curiosity. One of the things that it has taught me is that we can actually resurrect and remake ourselves over and over again, become something new and get involved in different mediums and areas and have it all coexist.

India's youth cannot be giving up, they can't be disillusioned because that is quite frankly a cop-out. What's harder is to roll up your sleeves and figure out piece by piece how to make things better. Anything that has actually worked here hasn't been a magic bullet. It's just been small successes that have weaved themselves together. To me our country gets hit twice, first by low education levels and then by the missing presence of educated women in the workforce. That's not to say the women are not contributing. We all know that they are in many visible and all too many invisible majors, but I am a strong believer that educating adolescent girls and